

Two Sessions Before Census Night

Census night: Tuesday 11 August 2026. You have tonight (Wednesday 5 August) and Monday 10 August. Everything below fits those two sessions.

Print list

PRINT	FOR	PAGES
census-esl-handouts-1-4.pdf	Tonight	16 A4, double-sided → 8 sheets
census-esl-handouts-5-6.pdf	Monday	10 A4, double-sided → 5 sheets

Every handout ends with its own answer pages, and every answer carries a short reason and a fuller one. Learners mark their own work — that is the point, since checking your own form is the real-world skill.

	EXERCISES	ANSWERS
Handout 1	pp. 1–2	pp. 3–4
Handout 2	pp. 5–6	pp. 7–8
Handout 3	pp. 9–10	pp. 11–12
Handout 4	pp. 13–14	pp. 15–16
Handout 5	pp. 1–2	pp. 3–5
Handout 6	pp. 6–7	pp. 8–9

To withhold the answers, print only pages 1–2, 5–6, 9–10, 13–14 of the Wednesday file and 1–2, 6–7, 10 of the Monday file.

Page 10 of the Monday file is **My Census Plan** — the take-home checklist. Print it single-sided as well, one per learner, and hand it out at the very end. If a learner keeps only one piece of paper from the whole week, that's the one.

Bring

- A **blue or black pen for every learner**. Handout 2 does not work without one.
- A **real blank Census form or the ABS sample on each table** — essential for Monday. Handouts 5 and 6 send learners into the actual 26 pages to find question numbers and follow skip instructions. Navigating an authentic document is the skill.
- **Address cards** for Handout 3 (six to eight invented Australian addresses on cut-up card). Ten minutes to make.

Tonight — Wednesday 5 August

The goal: a learner who comes tonight and misses Monday can still attempt the form.

0:00	Handout 1 — Census night is Tuesday 11 August	50 min
0:50	Handout 2 — How to write your answers	50 min
1:40	Handout 3 — Where do you live?	50 min
2:30	Handout 4 — Who is in your house?	50 min

Keys are in TIER-1-TEACHER-PACK.md.

If you have two hours, not three and a half: run Handouts 1, 2 and 4, and move Handout 3 to Monday. Address format is easier to catch up on than *who counts as present*, which is the question people actually get wrong.

End tonight by saying the date out loud and writing it on the board. Tuesday 11 August. Some learners will not come back on Monday.

The goal: they can navigate all 65 questions, and they know how to get help in their own language the following night.

0:00	Warmer — recycle Handout 4: <i>present, away, usually lives</i>	10 min
0:10	Handout 5 — Going through the form	55 min
1:05	Handout 6 — Getting help, and being ready	55 min
2:00	Hand out My Census Plan , read it through together, everyone takes it home	10 min

Do not skip the role-play in Handout 6. Three calls, three different partners, fewer notes each time. Tomorrow night is when they'll need it, and a phrase you have said aloud to three people is a phrase you can use under pressure.

Keys — Handout 5, Going through the form

B. Words — 1 b · 2 d · 3 a · 4 e · 5 f · 6 g · 7 c · 8 h (*also printed on the learner answer page*)

C. Understand — a **21** · b **48** · c **61** · d **17** · e **24** · f **60**

Let learners hunt in the real form rather than telling them. Finding a question number in a 26-page document is the point of the task.

The three-questions box is worth slowing down for. *Optional* (Q24, religion) and *Prefer not to answer* (Q9 gender, Q57 sexual orientation) are the form's own words. Teach them as vocabulary and move on — no discussion, no examples from the room. Everything else on the form should be answered, and the honest answer to "but what about my situation?" is the help line.

D. Practise

- Skip instructions — Q17 Australia → **19** · Q21 English only → **23** · Q30 No → **32** · Q38 no job → **50** · Q58 no one away → **60**
- One box or all — a **1** · b **ALL** (up to four ancestries) · c **ALL** · d **ALL** (more than one method of travel) · e **1**
- Three mistakes: *tomas* is in **small letters**; the **age does not match the date of birth** (born 1997 → 29, not 45); **Q18 is blank** when it should have his year of arrival, because he wasn't born in Australia. (Q22 *Well* is fine — say so, or they'll hunt for a fourth.)

E. Do it — TOMAS / SILVA / 29 / Unrelated flatmate or co-tenant of Person 1 / Other (specify) BRAZIL / 2019 / Yes, other language: PORTUGUESE / Well

Keys — Handout 6, Getting help, and being ready

B. Words — 1 d · 2 b · 3 g · 4 h · 5 a · 6 e · 7 f · 8 c

C. Understand — 1 c · 2 d · 3 a · 4 b · 5 e

All five come straight from page 2 and page 26 of the form. Send learners to those pages to check their own answers.

D. Practise — no fixed answers. Listen for the three phrases that matter most: *I need an interpreter who speaks _____*, *Could you explain that in easier English?*, and *Let me check that I understood*. Everything else is a bonus.

E. Do it — the checklist is the learner's own. Read it aloud together, line by line, and have them tick what is already true. Anything unticked is what they do between Monday night and Tuesday.

What this does not cover

Handouts 7–12 of the full plan — the work, education, health, transport and housing blocks in depth. They're not lost, they're just not urgent: those are ordinary settlement-English topics that happen to use the Census as their text, and they stay useful all

year. Handout 5 gives learners enough navigation to get through those sections of the form next Tuesday, which is what this week is for.

After Census night, if you want to keep going, pick up at Handout 9 (work: job, tasks, industry). It's the one with the most direct employability payoff, and the *occupation / main tasks / industry* distinction is the same one every résumé and job application asks for.

Adapted from the Census Household Form, © Commonwealth of Australia 2026, Australian Bureau of Statistics.